as one P.S.A.K. Pulavar, a boat contractor, insisted on full settlement of his dues of Rs 4,000 rather than the half that had been paid.[72] Meanwhile, *India* reported that the *Lawoe* was ready to sail but could not because of shortage of crew.[73] Perhaps the company was unable to retain the crew as they were unable to pay them.

In August, 'Galle-nesan' reported that the last instalment had been paid for the *Gallia*, and it would start sailing.[74] Conflicting reports on the final settlement had been rife for a long time. In the first week of February, the Tuticorin DSP had confirmed a report in *The Hindu* that the last instalment for the purchase of the *Gallia* had indeed been paid.[75] It is not entirely clear why the full settlement of the purchase price of the *Gallia* had taken so long. But it does appear that at last the full payment was made in August 1909. SSNCo was now in full ownership of the *Gallia* for what it was worth.

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It was in this context that, on 15 August 1909, the annual report for the year ending 31 March 1909 noted above was issued. According to the balance sheet, though the authorized share capital had been doubled from the original Rs 10 lakh during the year, the paid-up capital had increased only by Rs 1,33,684 to Rs 7,66,795 from Rs 6,33,111 the previous year. A 6 per cent debenture loan of Rs 3 lakh with 300 bonds of Rs 1,000 each had also been issued; but only 107 bonds had been taken. Rs 62,000 had been raised by mortgaging the *Lawoe*. During the accounting period, the 'Bills payable' and 'Sundry creditors' had increased by Rs 57,444 while the 'establishment security deposit' had come down by Rs 1,715. The book value of assets had gone from Rs 5,97,627-11-3 to Rs 6,50,153-13-4 due largely to the purchase of new boilers for the *Gallia* at a cost of Rs 44,222-9-0. The loss during the reporting year was Rs 2,51,109. All the three vessels had let down SSNCo. If the chartered *Ipswich* proved to be unseaworthy,[76] the *Gallia* remained a 'dead investment' and the *Lawoe* was laid up for most of the latter half of the year.